

AFL-CIO LEGISLATIVE SCORECARD

2024

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard>
Retrieved 8 August 2026
Records 22 House, 7 Senate

HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

1. S.J.Res. 38, Dealing with Buy America Requirements

S.J.Res. 38 · January 11, 2024
Position Bad for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 209 NAYs 198
This joint resolution nullifies the final rule issued by the Federal Highway Administration titled Waiver of Buy America Requirements for Electric Vehicle Chargers and published on Feb. 21, 2023. The rule temporarily waives the Buy America requirements for steel, iron, manufactured products and construction materials in electric vehicle (EV) chargers.
Alert Letter Opposing Legislation That Would Reverse Buy American Provision
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2024/house/sjres-38-dealing-buy-america-requirements>

2. H.J.Res. 98, Resolution of Disapproval on Joint Employer Rule

H.J.Res. 98 · January 12, 2024
Position Bad for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 206 NAYs 177
The AFL-CIO opposed the vote to overturn the National Labor Relations Board's 2023 Joint Employer Rule. The rule restores a reasonable standard recognizing entities with control over working conditions as joint employers, ensuring compliance with the National Labor Relations Act and protecting workers' rights to collective bargaining. Overriding the veto would revert to a restrictive Trump-era standard, creating uncertainty and undermining workers' rights without substantiated threats to business models like franchising or staffing services.
Alert Letter Opposing Legislation That Would Undermine Workers' Organizing Efforts
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2024/house/hjres-98-resolution-disapproval-joint-employer-rule-0>

3. H.R. 485, Dealing with Drug Prices

H.R. 485 · February 7, 2024
Position Bad for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 211 NAYs 208
H.R. 485 would ban Medicare, Medicaid and other federal programs from using effectiveness data in drug pricing, driving up costs and threatening preventive care funding. Instead of strengthening safeguards against discrimination, it broadly blocks all similar measures, undermining existing protections. The AFL-CIO urged opposition to H.R. 485 to protect fair drug pricing and affordable health care.
Alert Letter Opposing Legislation That Would Weaken the Government's Ability to Negotiate Prescription Drug Prices
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2024/house/hr-485-dealing-drug-prices>

4. H.Res. 863, Dealing with the Impeachment of Secretary Alejandro Mayorkas

H.Res. 863 · February 13, 2024
Position Bad for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 214 NAYs 213
This resolution constituted an unnecessary, costly and politically motivated attempt to impeach Department of Homeland Security Secretary Alejandro Mayorkas, based on partisan politics rather than a high crime or misdemeanor. It prioritized political stunts over addressing the real problems of working people.
Alert Letter Opposing Impeachment of Secretary of Homeland Security Alejandro Mayorkas
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2024/house/hres-863-dealing-impeachment-secretary-alejandro-mayorkas>

5. H.R. 6276, Dealing with Arbitrary Worksite Requirements for Federal Workers

H.R. 6276 · March 12, 2024

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 217 NAYs 203

This bill requires the Office of Management and Budget (OMB) and the General Services Administration (GSA) to establish methods and technologies to measure federal building usage. Federal agencies must collaborate with GSA to monitor occupancy using sensors and report on actual space utilization. OMB and GSA must ensure a minimum of 60% utilization in public buildings and federally leased spaces annually. A plan for consolidating federal agency headquarters buildings in the National Capital region is also required. Agencies must report occupancy data, and tenants falling below 60% usage for six months must return the space. Agencies with independent leasing authorities must report usage to Congress, and the GAO will monitor costs and occupancy. Buildings with less than 20% utilization must be reported for investigation.

Alert Letter Opposing Legislation that Would Undermine Federal Worker Efficiency

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2024/house/hr-6276-dealing-arbitrary-worksite-requirements-federal-workers>

6. H.J.Res. 98, Resolution of Disapproval on Joint Employer Rule

H.J.Res. 98 (Veto Override Vote) · May 7, 2024

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Failed YEAs 214 NAYs 191

The AFL-CIO opposed the vote to overturn the National Labor Relations Board's 2023 Joint Employer Rule. The rule restores a reasonable standard recognizing entities with control over working conditions as joint employers, ensuring compliance with the National Labor Relations Act and protecting workers' rights to collective bargaining. Overriding the veto would revert to a restrictive Trump-era standard, creating uncertainty and undermining workers' rights without substantiated threats to business models like franchising or staffing services.

Alert Letter Supporting the NLRB's Joint Employer Rule

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2024/house/hjres-98-resolution-disapproval-joint-employer-rule>

7. H.R. 7109, Dealing with Census Questions

H.R. 7109 · May 8, 2024

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 206 NAYs 202

This bill requires any questionnaire used in the decennial census to include a checkbox or other similar option for respondents to indicate whether the respondent and each household member is a U.S. citizen. The Department of Commerce must make public the number of citizens and noncitizens in each state. The bill also requires that the statement sent by the president to Congress indicating the number of persons in each state (related to the reapportionment of U.S. representatives) excludes noncitizens.

Alert Letter Opposing Legislation That Would Add Citizenship Question to Census

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2024/house/hr-7109-dealing-census-questions>

8. H.R. 3935, The FAA Reauthorization Act of 2024

H.R. 3935 · May 15, 2024

Position Good for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 387 NAYs 26

This bill reauthorizes the Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) through FY 2028, covering such activities as airport planning, facilities, equipment and operations, as well as reauthorizing the National Transportation Safety Board through FY 2028. It directs the FAA to increase air traffic controller hiring targets and establishes a workforce development program to support the education, recruitment and retention of aviation professionals. The bill also creates an FAA ombudsman to address inquiries or objections regarding aircraft certifications, pilot certificates and operational approvals. It raises the commercial airline pilot retirement age to 67, prohibits aircraft dispatchers from working remotely except in emergencies, and requires the Department of Transportation (DOT) to ensure the aircraft boarding and deplaning process is accessible for individuals with disabilities. DOT is also tasked with ensuring young children are seated next to an accompanying adult without additional fees when adjacent seats are available. The bill prohibits the FAA from requiring mask-wearing or COVID-19 vaccines for passengers, air carrier employees or FAA employees. It also requires the FAA to issue rules to update unmanned aircraft (drone) operations, including those beyond the visual line of sight, and to establish certification and operational rules for pilots of powered-lift aircraft capable of vertical takeoff and landing.

Alert House Letter Supporting the FAA Reauthorization Act of 2024

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2024/house/hr-3935-faa-reauthorization-act-2024>

9. Rosendale/Mace Amendment #53 to the Department of Homeland Security Appropriations Act, 2025

	H.R. 8752 · June 14, 2024
Position	Bad for working people
Outcome	Failed YEAs 188 NAYs 228
	Working people opposed the Part C Rosendale/Mace amendment #53 that would have prohibited funding to be used to carry out the Department of Homeland Security's (DHS's) memorandum titled "Worksite Enforcement: The Strategy to Protect the American Labor Market, the Conditions of the American Worksite, and the Dignity of the Individual." The DHS worksite enforcement memo aims to support effective enforcement of wage protections, workplace safety, labor rights, and other laws and standards that protect every worker in this country. The enforcement strategies outlined in this memo are key to reining in rampant wage theft, preventing needless workplace fatalities and combating the shameful resurgence of child labor in the 21st century. The practical effect of this amendment would be to allow unscrupulous employers to violate workers' rights with impunity.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2024/house/rosendalemace-amendment-53-department-homeland-security-appropriations

10. Perry Amendment #56 to the Servicemember Quality of Life Improvement and National Defense Authorization Act for Fiscal Year 2025

	H.R. 8070 · June 14, 2024
Position	Bad for working people
Outcome	Failed YEAs 188 NAYs 228
	This amendment is part of an effort to undermine official time. Official time permits federal union representatives to fulfill their duties of fair representation regardless of an employee's membership status. Official time also enables federal managers and employee representatives to collaboratively resolve workplace conflict, enhancing government efficiency and productivity.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2024/house/perry-amendment-56-servicemember-quality-life-improvement-and-national

11. Tiffany Amendment #58 to the Department of Homeland Security Appropriations Act, 2025

	H.R. 8752 · June 26, 2024
Position	Bad for working people
Outcome	Failed YEAs 190 NAYs 222
	Working people opposed the Part C Tiffany amendments #58 and #59 that would have prohibited the use of funds to extend temporary protected status (TPS) to any national of El Salvador and Honduras, respectively. These amendments would have stripped the rights and status away from hundreds of thousands of long-term members of our workforce, our communities and our unions, causing significant disruption to industries such as hospitality, food processing and construction. TPS is a pro-worker policy tool that provides significant benefits to working families at home and abroad. Country determinations should continue to be made through the process outlined by statute, not through politicized riders.
Alert	Letter Opposing Anti-Worker Amendments to the Homeland Security Appropriations Bill
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2024/house/tiffany-amendment-58-department-homeland-security-appropriations-act

12. Tiffany Amendment #59 to the Department of Homeland Security Appropriations Act, 2025

	H.R. 8752 · June 26, 2024
Position	Bad for working people
Outcome	Failed YEAs 191 NAYs 222
	Working people opposed the Part C Tiffany amendments #58 and #59 that would have prohibited the use of funds to extend temporary protected status (TPS) to any national of El Salvador and Honduras, respectively. These amendments would have stripped the rights and status away from hundreds of thousands of long-term members of our workforce, our communities and our unions, causing significant disruption to industries such as hospitality, food processing and construction. TPS is a pro-worker policy tool that provides significant benefits to working families at home and abroad. Country determinations should continue to be made through the process outlined by statute, not through politicized riders.
Alert	Letter Opposing Anti-Worker Amendments to the Homeland Security Appropriations Bill
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2024/house/tiffany-amendment-59-department-homeland-security-appropriations-act

13. H.R. 8281, Dealing with Requiring Proof of Citizenship to Vote

H.R. 8281 · July 10, 2024

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 221 NAYs 198

The SAVE Act creates unnecessary barriers to voter participation, especially for members of marginalized communities who may struggle to obtain additional layers of documentation. It limits acceptable IDs to passports, excluding others like REAL ID driver's licenses and military IDs unless coupled with additional documentation such as a birth certificate. This places an extreme burden on many Americans, including military personnel, Native Americans, those who have changed their names (particularly women), the elderly, the young and lower-income people.

Alert Letter Opposing Legislation that Would Create Unnecessary Barriers to Voter Participation

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2024/house/hr-8281-dealing-requiring-proof-citizenship-vote>

14. H.J.Res. 165, Resolution of Disapproval on Nondiscrimination Protections

H.J. Res. 165 · July 11, 2024

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 210 NAYs 205

The Department of Education's final rule is a critical step toward ensuring an education free from sex discrimination. This rule mandates that federally funded schools cannot discriminate based on sex, including against transgender individuals, and requires institutions of higher education to address off-campus sex discrimination affecting the educational environment. It draws on extensive feedback from students, parents, educators and other stakeholders, ensuring it reflects the needs and concerns of the educational community.

Alert Letter Opposing Legislation that Would Nullify Nondiscrimination Rules in Education

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2024/house/hjres-165-resolution-disapproval-nondiscrimination-protections>

15. H.R. 7887, Dealing with the Hiring Standards of Federal Contractors

H.R. 7887 · July 23, 2024

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Failed YEAs 178 NAYs 234

Working people did not support the ACCESS Act. Several of our affiliated unions raised significant concerns regarding this legislation. The bill would make it difficult for federal contracting officers to include apprenticeship utilization requirements (or any education requirement) in their solicitations for federal contracts for construction and services. Those in charge of maintenance and construction projects—as complex as a nuclear site cleanup—would be discouraged from seeking out a highly skilled workforce to perform the work. This bill would clear a path for using improperly or insufficiently trained workers on projects. We should encourage apprenticeships and training and skills development with taxpayer dollars, not discourage them at the expense of quality work completion or at the expense of safety for both workers and the public.

Alert Letter Opposing Legislation That Would Undermine Apprenticeships

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2024/house/hr-7887-dealing-hiring-standards-federal-contractors>

16. H.R. 8314, No Foreign Election Interference Act

H.R. 8314 · September 17, 2024

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Failed YEAs 218 NAYs 181

We are in total agreement that foreign actors should not be permitted to influence our elections, but the bill's approach to dealing with this issue and ambiguities in its provisions may lead to a slew of unintended, harmful consequences for U.S. citizens and their ability to fully engage the political process.

Alert Letter Opposing Rules Suspension to Pass "the Foreign Election Interference Act."

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2024/house/hr-8314-no-foreign-election-interference-act>

17. H.R. 5339, Dealing with the Responsibilities of Fiduciaries and Retirement Funds to Their Clients

H.R. 5339 · September 18, 2024

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 217 NAYs 206

Attempts to block retirement plans from considering environmental, social and governance ("ESG") principles would have deep impacts on retirees. ESGs are critical factors in assessing and mitigating risks and creating opportunities for enhanced returns.

Alert Letter Opposing Legislation that Would Effectively Disfranchise Retirement Plan Participants

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2024/house/hr-5339-dealing-responsibilities-fiduciaries-and-retirement-funds-their>

18. H.R. 5717, Dealing with Federal Funding for States and Localities

	H.R. 5717 · September 20, 2024
Position	Bad for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 219 NAYs 186
	Immigration enforcement is important, but singlemindedly prioritizing it over public safety and other law enforcement, as this bill does, is a terrible mistake. Despite being promoted as a vehicle to reduce crime, this bill would have quite the opposite effect. Put simply, when working people fear immigration consequences for engaging with local authorities, they are less likely to report crimes. In just one alarming illustration of the far-reaching consequences of this approach, a recent study of counties that actively cooperate with federal immigration enforcement documented a nearly 50% drop in reporting of workplace health and safety violations in key industries, and a corresponding increase in workplace injuries by roughly 24%. Clearly, when we allow conditions in which workers are afraid to file claims, we endanger workers physically and deepen the risk of other such workplace crimes as wage theft, discrimination and sexual harassment, which already are far too common.
Alert	Letter Opposing Legislation that Would Threaten Jobs, Public Safety and Working Families
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2024/house/hr-5717-dealing-federal-funding-states-and-localities

19. H.R. 82, Social Security Fairness Act of 2023

	H.R. 82 · November 12, 2024
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 327 NAYs 75
	The Windfall Elimination Provision (WEP) penalizes retirees who have spent their career in public service but who also have paid into Social Security at some point while working in the private sector. Although these retirees do not expect to receive Social Security benefits for their years of public sector service for which they did not pay FICA tax, it is not fair that their Social Security benefits for their private sector work—or for the private sector work of their spouses—are reduced as a result of a 1983 change in federal law intended to address the false perception that such federal retirees were “double dipping.” These provisions are grossly unfair as the Social Security benefits of private sector workers are not reduced if they receive benefits from private pension plans. These federal retirees have earned their Social Security benefits and should receive them. Together, the WEP-Government Pension Offset (GPO) provisions adversely affect approximately 25% of public sector workers. According to 2022 data, more than 2 million Social Security beneficiaries are affected by the WEP, and almost three-quarters of a million beneficiaries had spousal or widow(er) benefits reduced by the GPO.
Alert	Letter Supporting Legislation That Would Repeal Harmful Elements From How Retirement Benefits Are Calculated
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2024/house/hr-82-social-security-fairness-act-2023

20. H.R. 5342, Equal Treatment of Public Servants Act of 2023

	H.R. 5342 · November 12, 2024
Position	Bad for working people
Outcome	Failed YEAs 175 NAYs 225
	Working people opposed the Equal Treatment of Public Servants Act of 2023, which would improve benefits for some Windfall Elimination Provision (WEP)-affected people in the short term but would, in the future, expose about a half-million new people to WEP. It also would do nothing to address the spouses and survivors whose benefits are reduced by the Government Pension Offset provisions, either now or in the future.
Alert	Letter Supporting Legislation That Would Repeal Harmful Elements From How Retirement Benefits Are Calculated
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2024/house/hr-5342-equal-treatment-public-servants-act-2023

21. H.R. 9495, Dealing with Tax Exemptions for Nonprofit Organizations

	H.R. 9495 · November 21, 2024
Position	Bad for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 219 NAYs 184
	The ability to revoke tax-exempt status and thereby hamstring or put out of commission any nonprofit organization based on accusations without evidence or without a fair hearing would set a dangerous precedent, allowing the government to stifle dissent and for officeholders to punish critics, chilling freedom of speech and association. It is through the exercise of these freedoms that working people organize, collectively bargain and petition their government. It is precisely at a time when the incoming president-elect has identified various American citizens and American institutions as “enemies of the people” or “enemies from within” that Congress should be especially circumspect about expanding executive power, especially power that lacks real due process for Americans and their organizations, including their unions.
Alert	Letter Opposing Legislation that Would be Open to Abuse by the Treasury

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2024/house/hr-9495-dealing-tax-exemptions-nonprofit-organizations>

22. H.R. 7198, Dealing with the Regulatory Process

H.R. 7198 · December 5, 2024

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 208 NAYs 196

Under a slew of existing laws, the rulemaking process generally requires notice, public comments, studies and cost-benefit analyses. It already takes into special account the effects any proposed rule might have on small businesses and other small entities. Under the existing Regulatory Flexibility Act, an agency must either certify that a proposed rule will not have a significant economic impact on a substantial number of small entities, or conduct both an initial and a final regulatory flexibility analysis, along with periodic reviews of its impact on an ongoing basis. In other words, the law is already very rigorous and comprehensive in minimizing impacts of rulemakings on small businesses. But after a lifesaving workplace safety rule clears all these existing hurdles, after all the public comment, the studies, the expert analyses, the reviews and so on, H.R. 7198 would invest in one person—the chief counsel of a Small Business Administration (SBA) office—the authority to roll back the rule whenever trade associations representing giant corporations file a petition challenging an agency’s certification that a regulatory flexibility analysis was not required.

Alert Letter Opposing Legislation That Would Give Big Trade Association A New Way to Thwart Pro-Worker Rulemakings

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2024/house/hr-7198-dealing-regulatory-process>

SENATE

1. S.J.Res. 38, Dealing with Buy America Requirements

S.J.Res. 38 · February 29, 2024

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Failed YEAs 50 NAYs 47

This joint resolution nullifies the final rule issued by the Federal Highway Administration titled Waiver of Buy America Requirements for Electric Vehicle Chargers and published on Feb. 21, 2023. The rule temporarily waives the Buy America requirements for steel, iron, manufactured products and construction materials in electric vehicle (EV) chargers.

Alert Letter Opposing Resolution that Would Undercut Electric Vehicle Infrastructure

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2024/senate/sjres-38-dealing-buy-america-requirements>

2. S.J.Res. 49, Resolution of Disapproval on Joint Employer Rule

S.J.Res. 49 · April 10, 2024

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 50 NAYs 48

The AFL-CIO opposed the vote to overturn the National Labor Relations Board’s 2023 Joint Employer Rule. The rule restores a reasonable standard recognizing entities with control over working conditions as joint employers, ensuring compliance with the National Labor Relations Act and protecting workers’ rights to collective bargaining. Overriding the veto would revert to a restrictive Trump-era standard, creating uncertainty and undermining workers’ rights without substantiated threats to business models like franchising or staffing services.

Alert Letter Opposing Legislation that Would Overturn the NLRB’s Joint Employer Rule

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2024/senate/sjres-49-resolution-disapproval-joint-employer-rule>

3. H.R. 3935, The FAA Reauthorization Act of 2024

H.R. 3935 · May 9, 2024

Position Good for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 88 NAYs 4

This bill reauthorizes the Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) through FY 2028, covering such activities as airport planning, facilities, equipment and operations, as well as reauthorizing the National Transportation Safety Board through FY 2028. It directs the FAA to increase air traffic controller hiring targets and establishes a workforce development program to support the education, recruitment and retention of aviation professionals. The bill also creates an FAA ombudsman to address inquiries or objections regarding aircraft certifications, pilot certificates and operational approvals. It raises the commercial airline pilot retirement age to 67, prohibits aircraft dispatchers from working remotely except in emergencies, and requires the Department of Transportation (DOT) to ensure the aircraft boarding and deplaning process is accessible for individuals with disabilities. DOT is also tasked with ensuring young children are seated next to an accompanying adult without additional fees when adjacent seats are available. The bill prohibits the FAA from requiring mask-wearing or COVID-19 vaccines for

passengers, air carrier employees or FAA employees. It also requires the FAA to issue rules to update unmanned aircraft (drone) operations, including those beyond the visual line of sight, and to establish certification and operational rules for pilots of powered-lift aircraft capable of vertical takeoff and landing.

Alert Senate Letter Supporting the FAA Reauthorization Act of 2024

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2024/senate/hr-3935-faa-reauthorization-act-2024>

4. S. 4381, Right to Contraception Act

S. 4381 · June 5, 2024

Position Good for working people

Outcome Failed YEAs 51 NAYs 39

A bill to protect an individual's ability to access contraceptives and to engage in contraception, and to protect a health care provider's ability to provide contraceptives, contraception and information related to contraception.

Alert Letter Supporting Legislation That Would Protect the Right to Contraception

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2024/senate/s-4381-right-contraception-act>

5. P.N. 1357, Confirmation of Anne Marie Wagner to the Federal Labor Relations Authority

P.N. 1357 · July 10, 2024

Position Good for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 55 NAYs 37

Working people supported the confirmation of Anne Marie Wagner to the Federal Labor Relations Authority (FLRA). Wagner is highly qualified to be a member of the FLRA. She brings decades of experience with the Office of Special Counsel, the Merit Systems Protection Board and the U.S. Government Accountability Office Personnel Appeals Board to the FLRA. Wagner's experience with federal employee relations and appeals led the Senate Committee on Homeland Security & Government Affairs to report her nomination with a strong bipartisan vote.

Alert Letter Supporting Nomination of Ann Wagner as a Member of the FLRA

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2024/senate/pn-1357-confirmation-anne-marie-wagner-federal-labor-relations>

6. P.N. 1789, Confirmation of Lauren McFerran as Chair of the National Labor Relations Board

P.N. 1789 · December 11, 2024

Position Good for working people

Outcome Failed YEAs 49 NAYs 50

The NLRB is the sole venue whereby most private sector workers' rights to organize and collectively bargain are enforced. With workers turning to the board for representation elections and the enforcement of their rights in increasing numbers, the agency's seats need to be filled to tackle this increasing workload. And it is vital that the board is composed of individuals like Chair McFerran who believe in its mission.

Alert Letter Supporting Renomination of Lauren McFerran as Chair of the NLRB

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2024/senate/pn-1789-confirmation-lauren-mcferran-chair-national-labor-relations>

7. S. 597, Social Security Fairness Act

H.R. 82 (S. 597) · December 21, 2024

Position Good for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 76 NAYs 20

The Windfall Elimination Provision (WEP) penalizes retirees who have spent their career in public service but who also have paid into Social Security at some point while working in the private sector. Although these retirees do not expect to receive Social Security benefits for their years of public sector service for which they did not pay FICA tax, it is not fair that their Social Security benefits for their private sector work—or for the private sector work of their spouses—are reduced as a result of a 1983 change in federal law intended to address the false perception that such federal retirees were “double dipping.” These provisions are grossly unfair as the Social Security benefits of private sector workers are not reduced if they receive benefits from private pension plans. These federal retirees have earned their Social Security benefits and should receive them. Together, the WEP-Government Pension Offset (GPO) provisions adversely affect approximately 25% of public sector workers. According to 2022 data, more than 2 million Social Security beneficiaries are affected by the WEP, and almost three-quarters of a million beneficiaries had spousal or widow(er) benefits reduced by the GPO.

Alert Letter Supporting Legislation That Would Repeal Harmful Elements From How Retirement Benefits Are Calculated

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2024/senate/s-597-social-security-fairness-act>